

DASC7606 -8

Deep Learning

Large Language Models (LLM)
and
“Generative Pre-trained Transformer” GPT

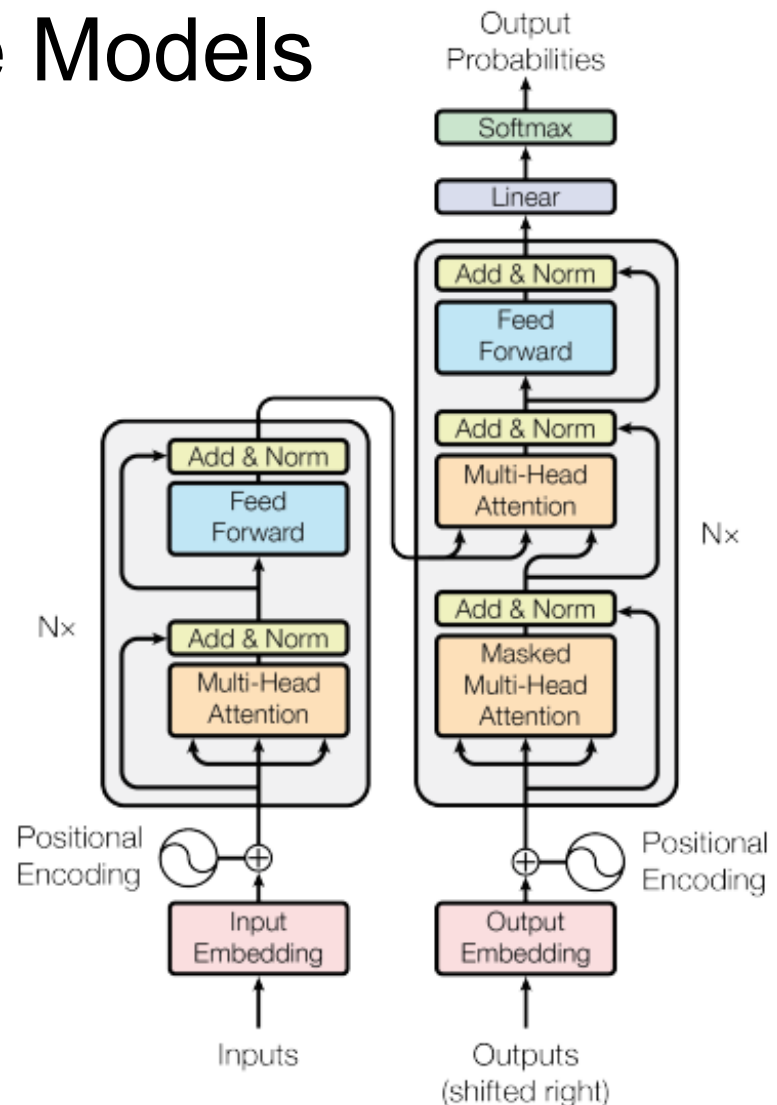
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2025



Large Language Models

- Word Embedding
 - Word2Vec (CBOW)
 - Evaluation
 - ELMo
- Seq2Seq – Machine Translation
- Attention and Transformer
- **BERT**
 - Architecture and pre-training
 - Using BERT for word embeddings
 - Using BERT for other NLP tasks
 - Tokenization
- Language Model and LLM
- Open AI, GPTs, ChatGPT
- BART - another Pre-trained Large Language Model (LLM)
- Prompting and In-Context Learning



BERT (Bidirectional Encoder Representations from Transformers)



Both ELMo and BERT
are cartoons from Sesame Street



ELMo = Embeddings from Language Model

BERT: Pre-training of Deep Bidirectional Transformers for Language Understanding, 2018

BERT: Architecture and pre-training

BERT uses the encoder mechanism of the Transformer.

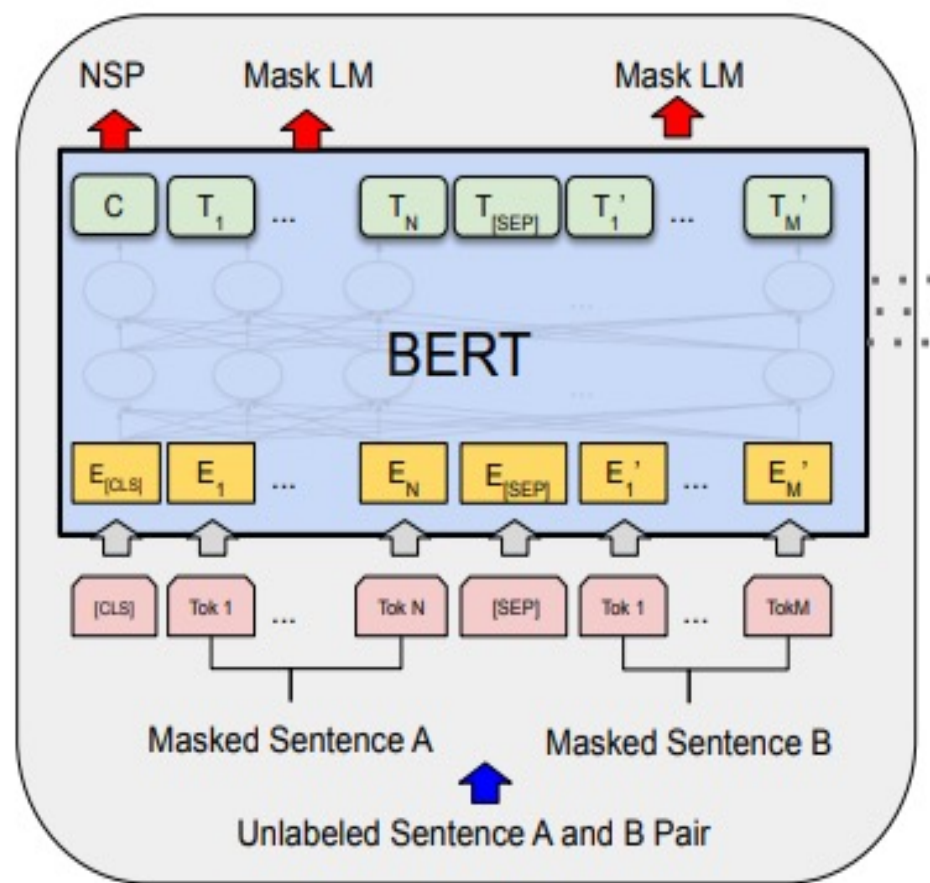
Pre-training of BERT

Masked LM Training:

Mask 15% of the words, predict the masked words, based on the non-masked words in the sequence

Next Sentence Prediction (NSP):

Binary classifier is trained to predict whether one sentence is the next sentence of another (using 50% subsequent pairs and 50% random).



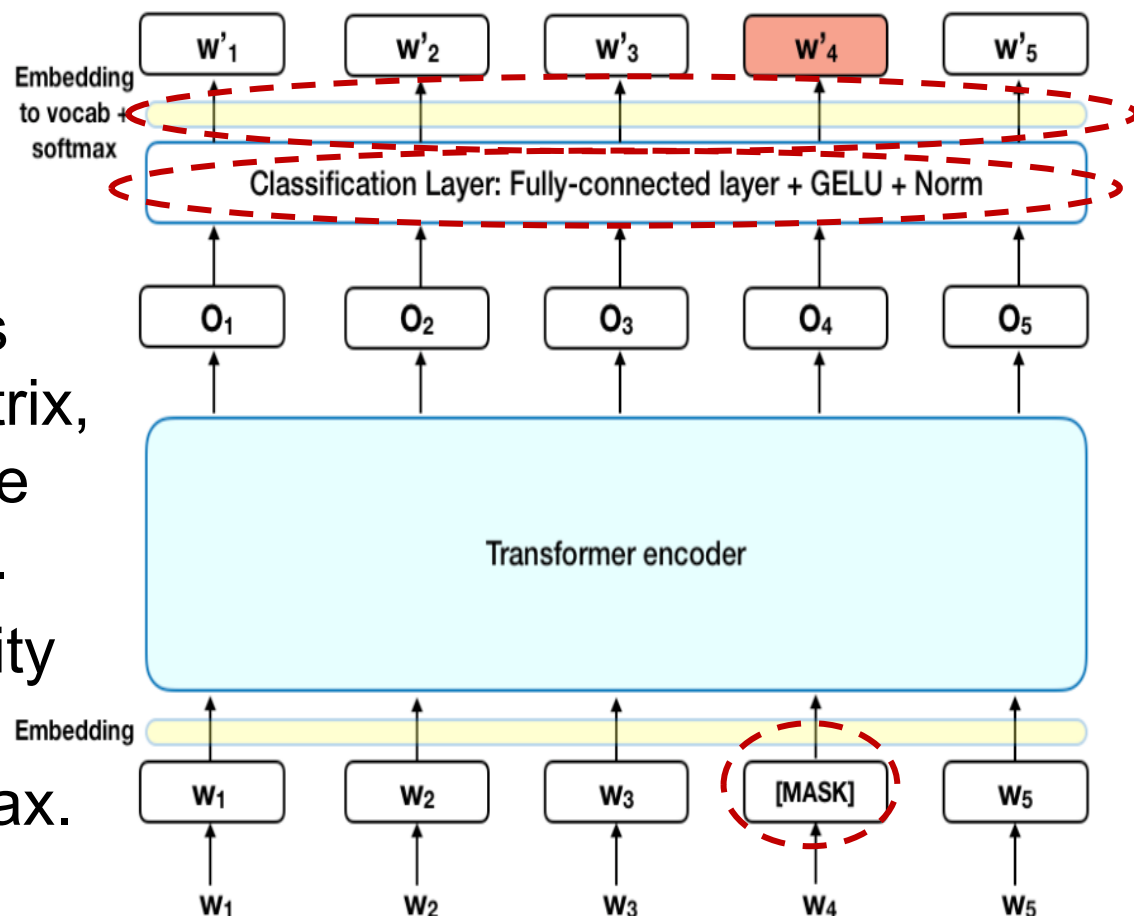
Pre-training



BERT – Mask Training

Mask Training: Mask 15% of the words, predict the masked words, based on the non-masked words in the sequence (CBOW)

- Add a classification layer on top of the encoder output.
- Multiply output vectors by the embedding matrix, transform them into the vocabulary dimension.
- Calculate the probability of each word in the vocabulary with softmax.



BERT: Architecture and pre-training

Advantages

- Masked token prediction better than next token prediction (e.g., RNN which is only sequentially and not the whole context)
- Transformer attention gives varying weight to different parts of input data
 - ‘reading’ often associates with ‘hate’
 - Attention makes better prediction e.g., if ‘Jacob’ is an avid reader, more attention to ‘Jacob’ than to ‘reading’ and choose ‘love’ instead of ‘hate’.

Masked-language-modeling

The model is given a sequence of words with the goal of predicting a ‘masked’ word in the middle.

Example

Jacob [mask] reading

Jacob *fears* reading

Jacob *loves* reading

Jacob *enjoys* reading

Jacob *hates* reading

Masking word prediction

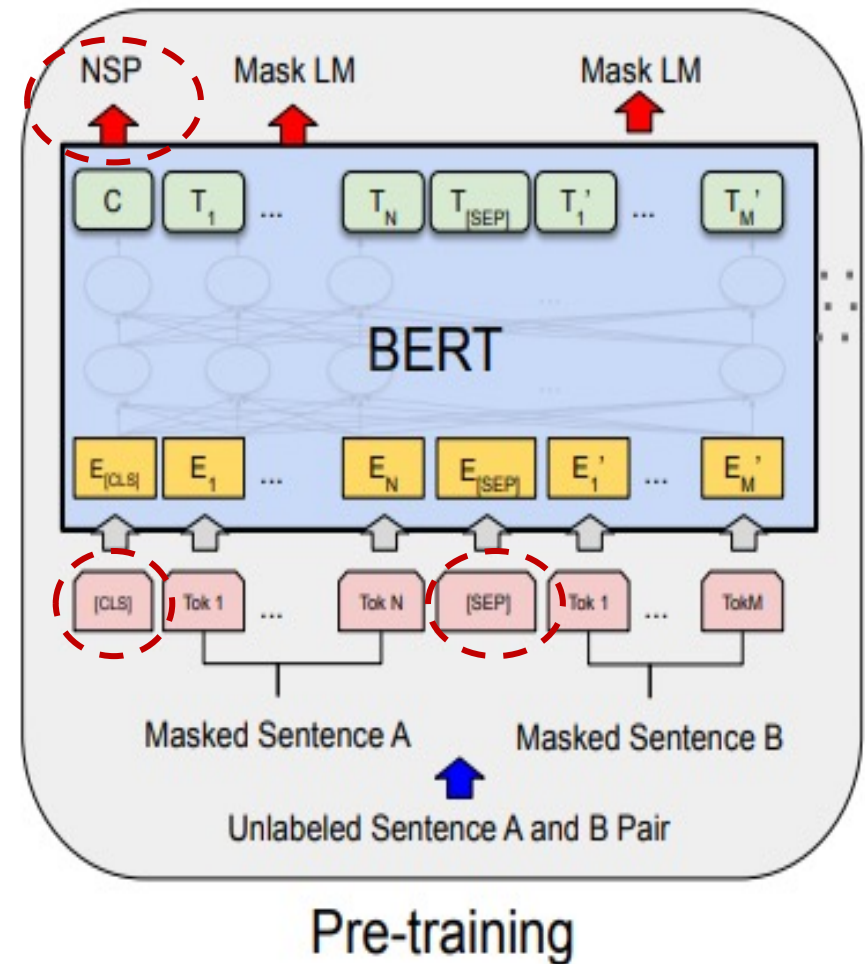
Learn from reconstructing the input

- **Fact:** University of Hong Kong is located in _____ , Hong Kong.
- **Syntax:** I put _____ fork down on the table.
- **Coreference:** The woman walked across the street, checking for traffic over _____ shoulder.
- **Semantics/topics:** I went to the ocean to see the fish, turtles, seals and _____.
- **Sentiment:** Overall, the food was delicious and the service was great, the restaurant was _____.
- **Reasoning:** Grace went to the kitchen to make tea, Beth was standing next to Grace. Beth later left the _____.
- **Arithmetic:** The answer of 3 multiply 9 is _____.



BERT Training: Next Sentence Prediction

- Input pairs of sentences ([CLS] token inserted at the beginning, [SEP] token at the end of each sentence)
- Learn if the second sentence follows the first sentence
- 50% are subsequent pairs, the other 50% are random
- Use a simple classification layer to calculate probability IsNextSequence with Softmax.
- NSP helps for tasks based on relationship between two sentences.

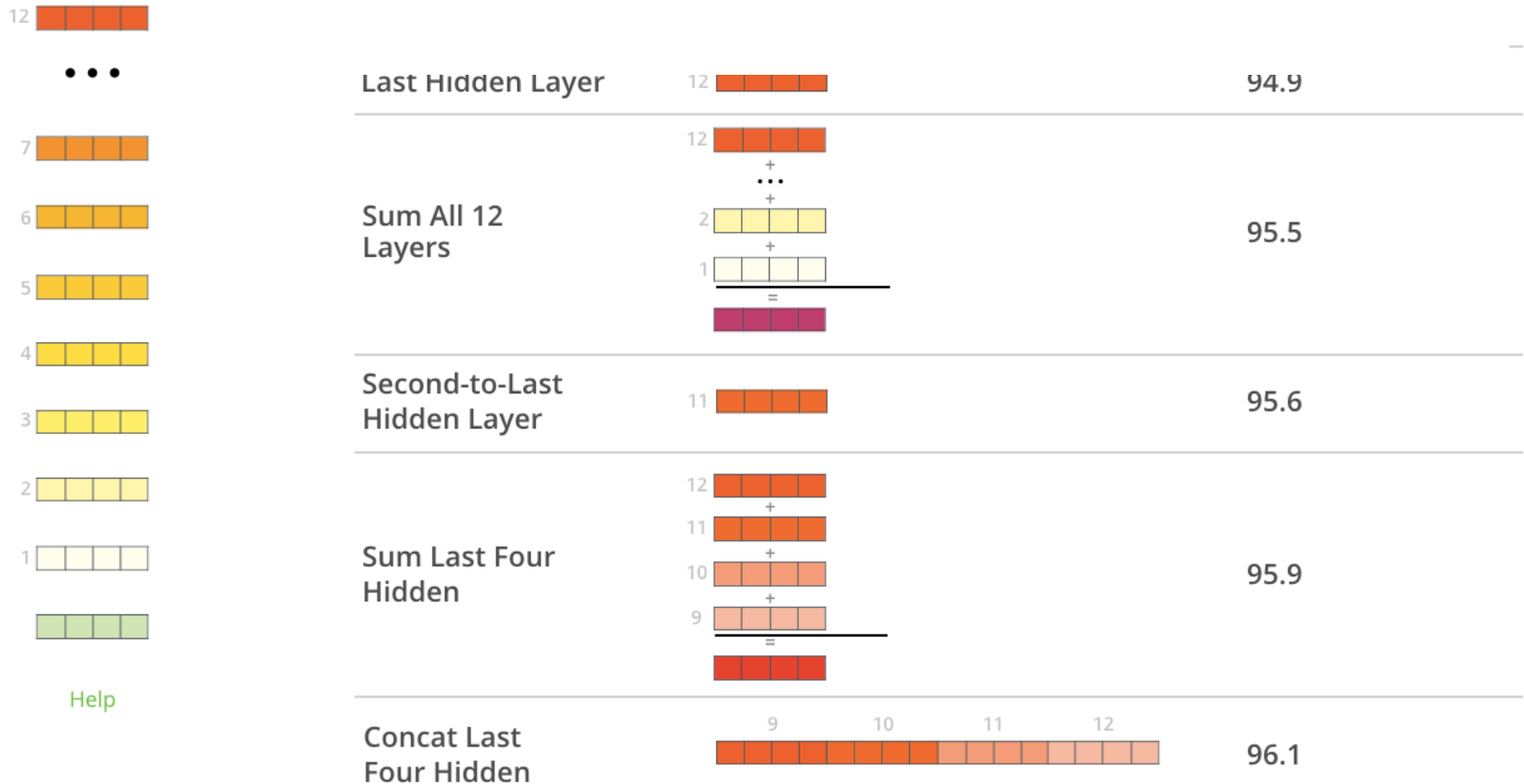


RoBERTa (A Robustly Optimized BERT Approach)
more data by dynamic masking, no Next Sentence Prediction.

Using BERT for Word Embeddings

What is the best contextualized embedding with 12 encoder blocks?

Dev F1 Score



Word Embedding: the last 4 layers give the best result.
(vector size: concatenation $4 \times 768 = 3072$ or summing 768).

Using BERT for Word Embeddings:

Contextually Dependent Vectors

- [CLS]⁰ After¹ stealing² money³ from⁴ the⁵ **bank**⁶ **vault**^{7,8} the⁹ **bank**¹⁰ **robber**¹¹ was¹² seen¹³ fishing¹⁴ on¹⁵ the¹⁶ Mississippi¹⁷ **river**¹⁸ **bank**^{19,20} [SEP]²¹
- Instances of “bank” at positions 6, 10, and 19, whose word vectors are summing the last 4 hidden layers
- First 5 vector values of their 768-vectors for each instance of “bank”
 - **bank**⁶ vault ([3.3596, -2.9805, -1.5421, 0.7065, 2.0031, ...])
 - **bank**¹⁰ robber ([2.7359, -2.5577, -1.3094, 0.6797, 1.6633, ...])
 - river **bank**¹⁹. ([1.5266, -0.8895, -0.5152, -0.9298, 2.8334, ...])

Observations:

- Word vectors for each instance of “bank” are different
- Cosine Vector Similarity of
 - **bank**⁶ vault and **bank**¹⁰ robber = 0.94
 - **bank**¹⁰ robber and **river bank**¹⁹ = 0.69



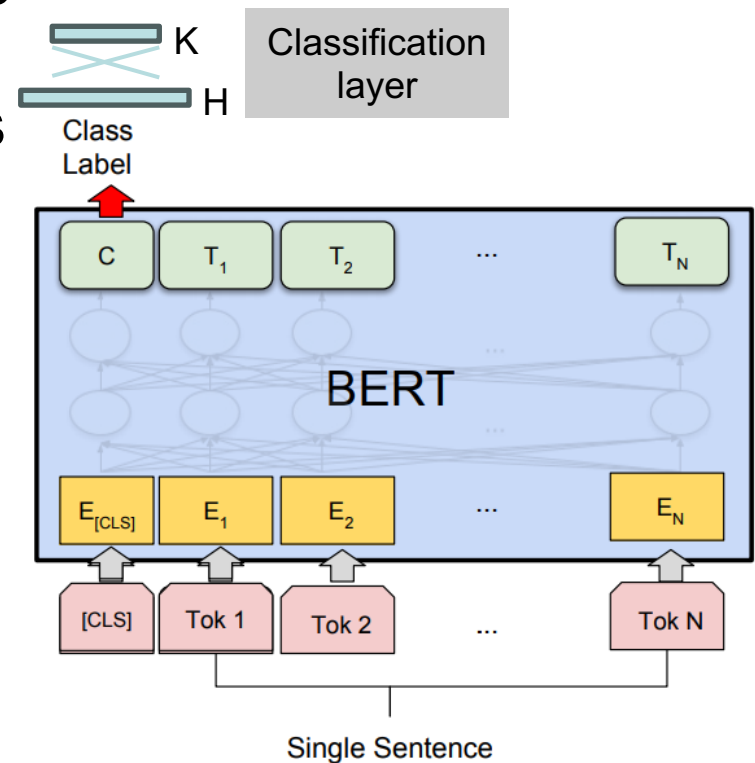
Using BERT for other NLP tasks (Fine tune)

- BERT can be used for a wide variety of language tasks, while only adding a small layer to the core model.
- In the fine-tuning training, most of the hyper-parameters stay the same as in BERT training.

Classification tasks

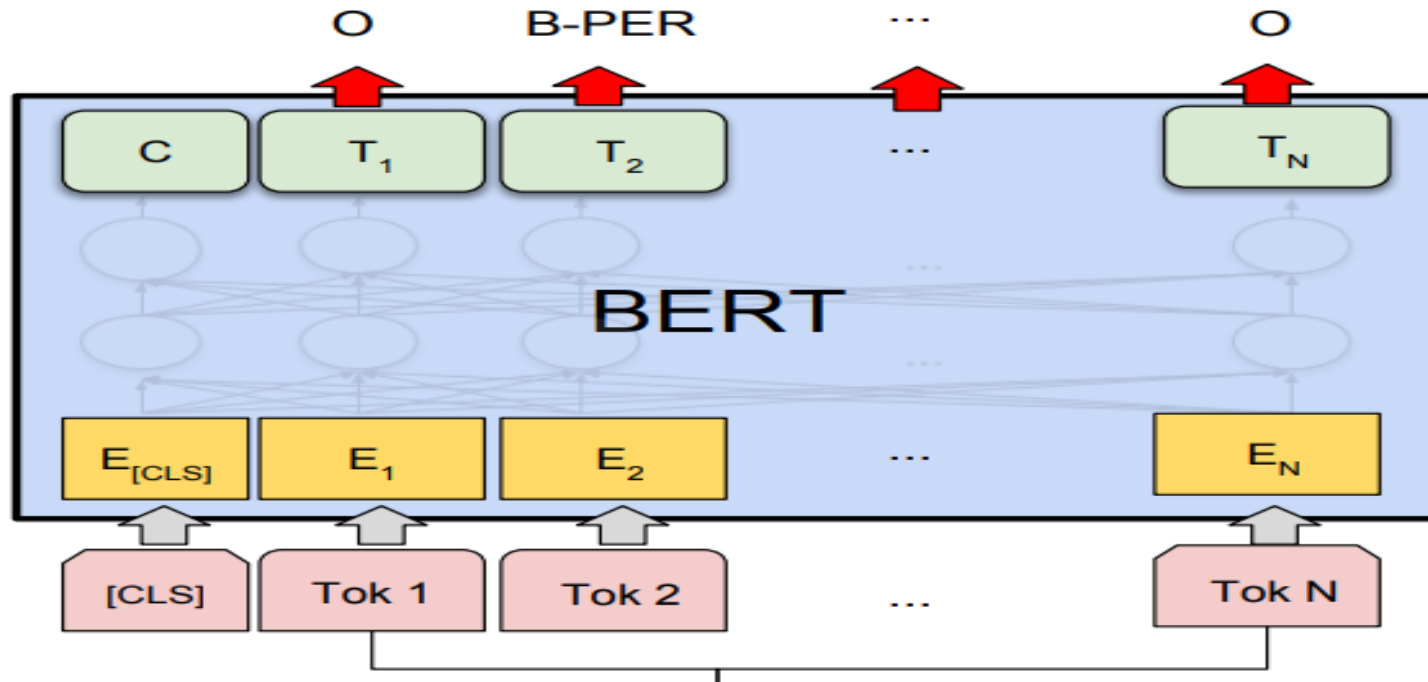
(single sentence sentiment analysis inferencing, semantic similarity, ...)

- Input sentence starts with **[CLS]**, separate/end with **[SEP]**
- A classification layer is added on the hidden states of **[CLS]** of dimension of $K \times H$, where K = number of classifier labels, H = size of the hidden state.
- Label probabilities are computed with a standard softmax.



Single Sentence Tagging

Named Entity Recognition (NER) marks entities (Person, Organization, Date, etc.) in the text



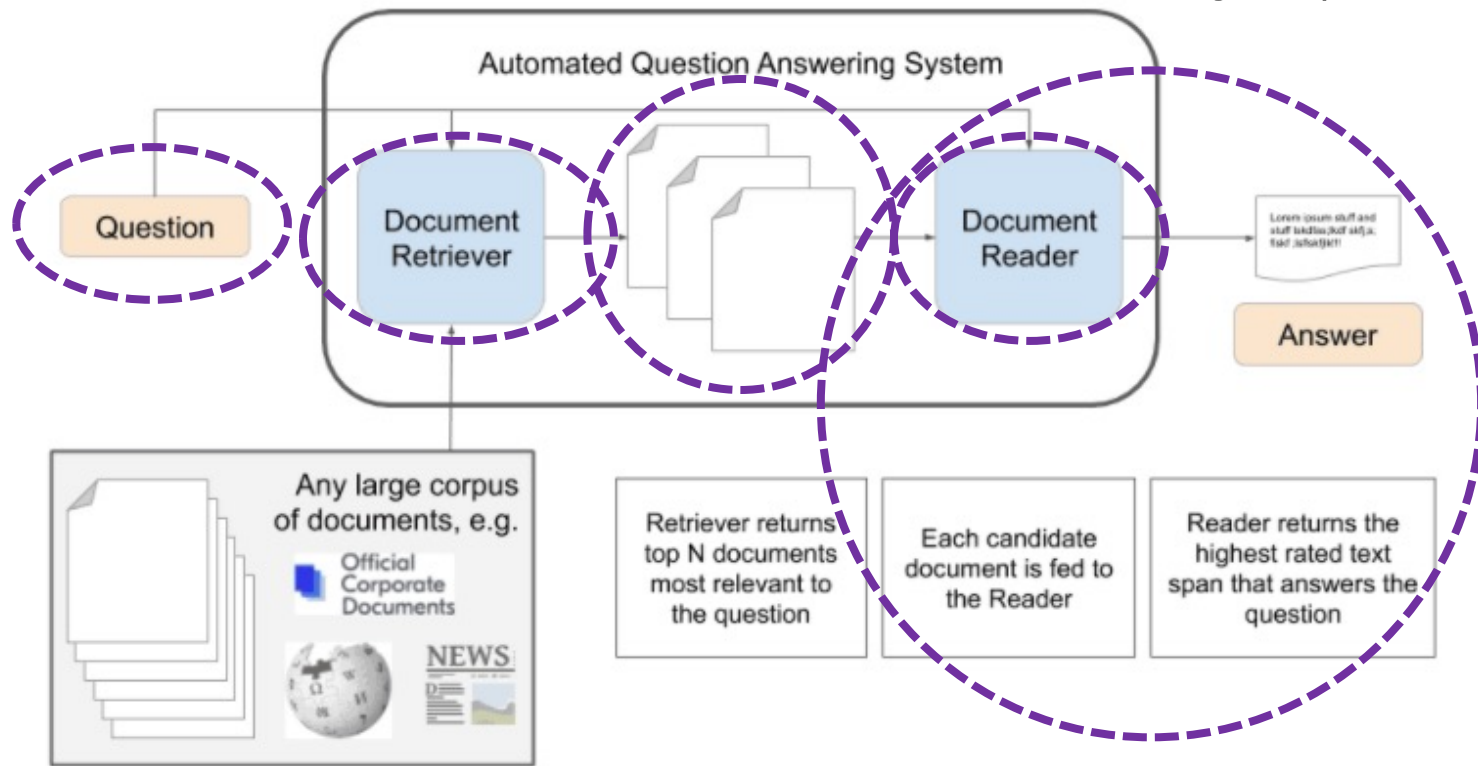
- A tag is predicted for each word
- Final hidden states (transformer output) of every input token is fed to the **classification layer** to get a prediction for every token.

Question and Answering System

Task: retrieve the answer to a question from a given text

Extractive Approach consist of retrieval and a reader

1. Query processing – extract keywords by part-of-speech
2. Document retrieval – search documents, retrieval contents
3. Passage retrieval – select relevant passages (smaller units)
4. Answer extraction - extract answer from passages (BERT)



Question and Answering System

Q: Of what group in the periodic table is oxygen a member?

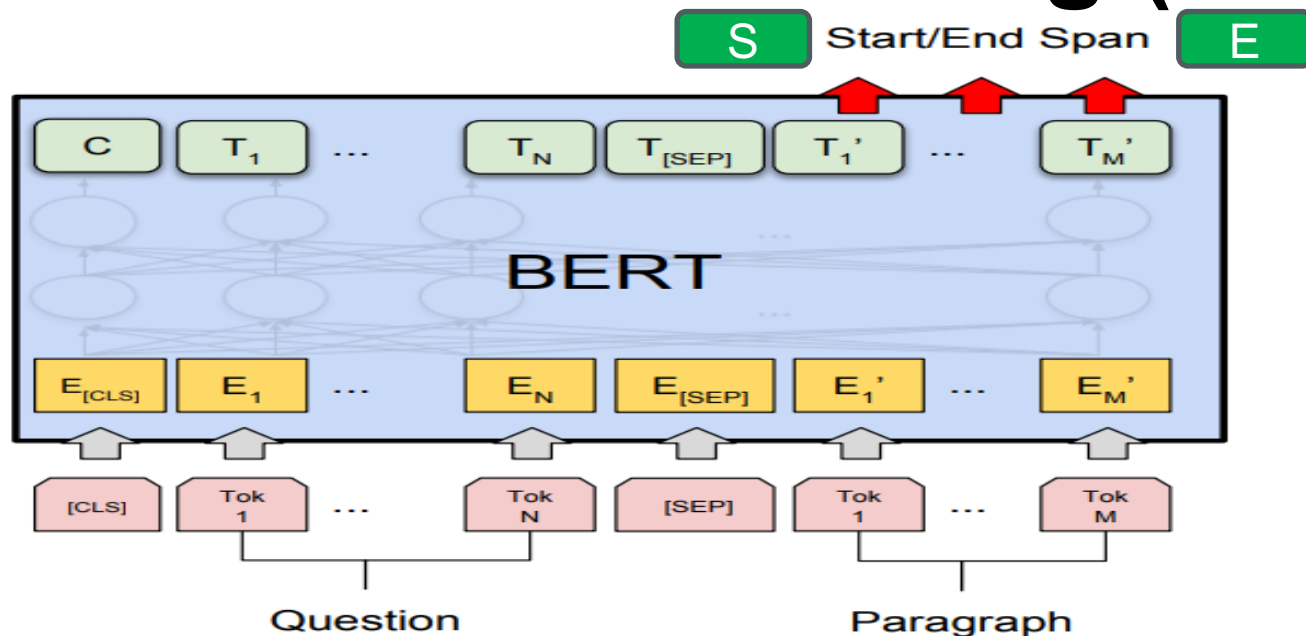
Q: What is the atomic number of oxygen?

Q: Is oxygen abundant?

Oxygen is a chemical element with symbol O and atomic number 8. It is a member of the chalcogen group on the periodic table and is a highly reactive nonmetal and oxidizing agent that readily forms compounds (notably oxides) with most elements. By mass, oxygen is the third-most abundant element in the universe, after hydrogen and helium. At standard temperature and pressure, two atoms of the element bind to form dioxygen, a colorless and odorless diatomic gas with the formula O₂.

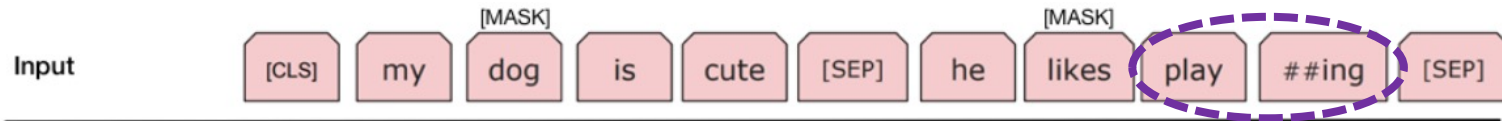
2. Diatomic oxygen gas constitutes 20.8% of the Earth's atmosphere. However, monitoring of atmospheric oxygen levels show a global downward trend, because of fossil-fuel burning. Oxygen is the most abundant element by mass in the Earth's crust as part of oxide compounds such as silicon dioxide, making up almost half of the crust's mass.

Question and Answering (Reader)



- Input: question and context paragraph (sentence pair task)
- Output: starting token and end token from the paragraph that answer the question (Token i with output T_i)
- Learn two new parameters:
start vector S and **end vector E** (same size as Token T_i)
- $\text{Prob}(\text{Token } i \text{ is answer start}) = \text{softmax}(S \cdot T_i)$
 $\text{Prob}(\text{Token } i \text{ is answer end}) = \text{softmax}(E \cdot T_i)$

Tokenization



Tokenization is the process of splitting a word, phrase, sentence, paragraph, or text documents into smaller units. (sentence, word, character tokenization)

Subword Tokenization (a balance between word-based and character-based tokenization) breaks words into smaller and meaningful pieces based on frequency and structure (Byte-Pair or WordPiece Tokenization)

Example: “embeddings” → ['em', '##bed', '##ding', '##s']

- ## denotes a preceding subword,
e.g., ‘##bed’ token denotes subword with suffix ‘bed’,
which is also a standalone token.

Tokenization in BERT

BERT tokenizer model (vocabulary size 30,000) contains :

1. Whole words
2. Subwords occurring at the front of a word or in isolation (“em” in “embeddings” or standalone word “em” – letter “m”)
3. Subwords preceded by ‘##’ (not at the front of a word)
4. Individual characters

Advantage: Reduce vocabulary size (size of the model) and possible to process unseen words by its subwords.

To tokenize a word

- first checks if the whole word is in the vocabulary.
- If not, break the word into the largest possible subwords in the vocabulary,
- As last resort, decompose the word into individual characters (Note that a word can always be represented as a collection of characters)

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Natural Language Processing (NLP)

- 1970-80's, early NLP is rule-based (by hand)
- 1990 - Using statistical inference to learn rules about “validity” through large collections of documents
- A **language model** (LM) is a probabilistic model that predicts the order of words in a sentence
 - $P(\text{“I love you”})$ is high; $P(\text{“eat pen north”})$ is low
- LM deduces “rules” about **validity** through statistics
 - **Spelling** - “breakfast”, “audio”, “chulling” $P(w) = 0$
 - **Grammar** - “I go”, “he goes”, “one book”, “two books”, “one water” $P(\text{“one water”}) = 0$
 - **Structure** - (subject – verb – object,...)

Statistical LM instead of Rule-based LM

Probability (next word)

Given a word string, $S = w_1 w_2 \dots w_n$, LM computes

$$- P(S) = P(w_1 w_2 \dots w_n) = P(w_1) P(w_2 | w_1) \dots P(w_n | w_1 \dots w_{n-1})$$

Language Model for Style

All work of
Shakespeare



Language
model



Base on LM (statistics),
the next word is generated
according to probability
 $P(w_n|w_1 \dots w_{n-1})$

KING LEAR:

O, if you were a feeble sight, the
courtesy of your law,

Your sight and several breath, will
wear the gods

With his heads, and my hands are
wonder'd at the deeds,

So drop upon your lordship's head,
and your opinion

Shall be against your honour.



Language Model for Style

Computer
Science
textbook
and Bible



Language
model

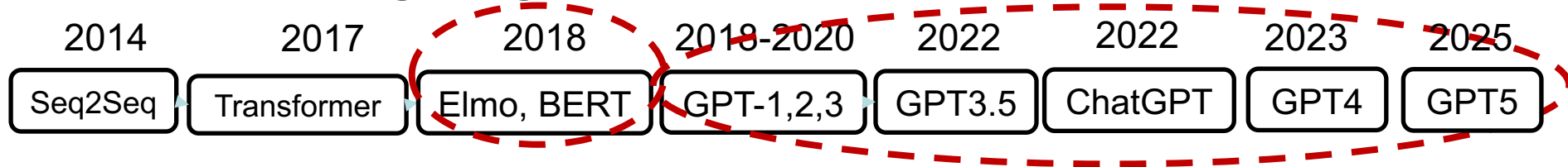


37:29 The righteous shall inherit
the land, and leave it for an
inheritance unto the children of
Gad according to the number of
steps that is linear in b .

hath it not been for the singular
taste of old Unix, “new Unix”
would not exist.



Language Model Development



- **GPT** stands for “**G**enerative **P**re-trained **T**ransformer”
- **G**enerative through Language Model $P(s_j | s_1 \dots s_{j-1})$, decoder of Transformer
- Prior to this work, NLP models (e.g., BERT combines Transformer with pretraining and self-supervised learning) were trained specifically on a particular task, like sentiment classification, textual entailment etc., using supervised learning.

Limitations:

- large amount of annotated data for learning a particular task which is often not easily available
- fail to generalize for tasks other than what they have been trained for.

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Open AI: GPT

Generative Pre-trained Transformer

Reference materials:

Aligning language models to follow instructions,
<https://openai.com/research/instruction-following>, Jan 2022

<https://chat.openai.com/> OpenAI. Nov 2022.

<https://openai.com/blog/introducing-text-and-code-embeddings>

<https://medium.com/walmartglobaltech/the-journey-of-open-ai-gpt-models-32d95b7b7fb2>

HKU Talk by Qi Liu, “How ChatGPT Obtains Its Ability and Its Impacts”, March 2023

GPT-4 Technical Report, March 2023, <https://arxiv.org/pdf/2303.08774.pdf>



What is Open AI?

Artificial Intelligence research laboratory and deployment company by Elon Musk in 2016.

Mission for OpenAI:

- advance artificial general intelligence (AGI) to benefit humanity (*Elon Musk is very vocal about danger of AI*)
- **non-profit to "capped" for-profit** in 2019 (partnered with Microsoft after Elon Musk stepped down in 2018)
- E. Musk sued CEO Sam Altman in 2024 shifting focus from public benefit to profit maximization, Altman countersued Musk for "bad-faith tactics" to slow the company's progress
- Partner with Microsoft (copilot), Nvidia...

GPT performs a wide variety of natural language tasks (with about 30 engineers and researchers)

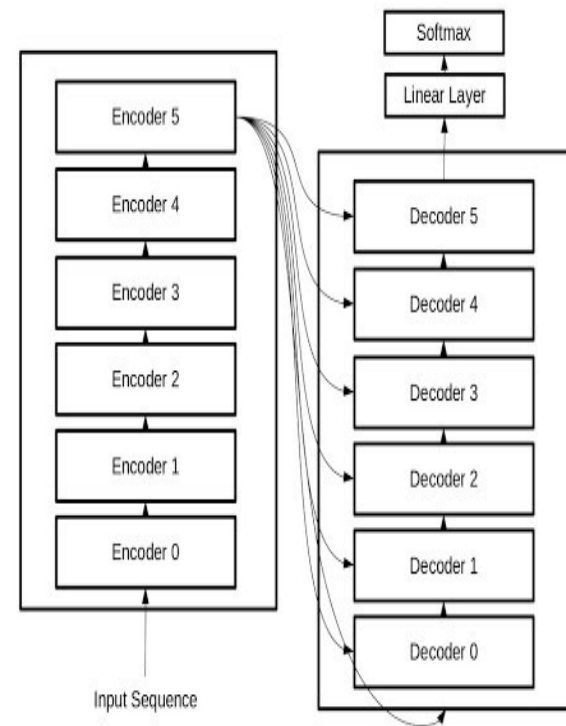
DALL.E creates realistic images and art from a description in natural language

SORA creates video from text



BERT vs GPT

- OpenAI's GPT uses only its **decoder** to generate outputs (uni-directional).
- BERT uses its **encoder** (bidirectional) to build a language model.
- GPT is much larger than BERT
 - BERT-base – 110M; large – 340M (2018)
 - GPT-1 -2 -3 -4 – 110M, 1.5B, 175B, 100T?
- BERT and GPT-1 need data and **fine-tune** models for specific downstream tasks
- GPT-3's allow users to reprogram it through instructions (prompts) and few-shot learning.
- **Few-shot learning** – predictions of output is based on the input of a few examples for each new class.



“Generative Pre-trained Transformer”- GPT

<https://medium.com/walmartglobaltech/the-journey-of-open-ai-gpt-models-32d95b7b7fb2>

- GPT models **compress world knowledge** through language modeling (**decoder-only Transformer model**),
- GPT can recover (memorize) the semantics of world knowledge and serve as a general-purpose task solver.
- Two key points to the success are
 - **Data** - training language models to accurately predict next word
 - **Compute** - scaling up the size of language models
- GPT-1 first **pretrain Transformer** with unlabeled data through
 - Unsupervised Learning (text T , window size k , NN parameter θ)

$$L_1(T) = \sum_i \log P(t_i | t_{i-k}, \dots, t_{i-1}; \theta) \quad (i)$$

- Then **fine-tune model** with examples on each downstream task, such as classification, sentiment...
 - Supervised fine-tuning (input $x_1, \dots, x_n$, observed label y)

$$L_2(C) = \sum_{x,y} \log P(y | x_1, \dots, x_n) \quad (ii)$$



GPT-1 (2018)

- Used 12-layer decoder, 12 attention heads, 117 million parameters and 768-dim word embedding
- Data from over 7,000 books (with mask)

For fine tuning on each task, inputs were transformed into ordered sequences (as BERT).

- Start and end tokens were added to the input sequences.
- A delimiter token added between different parts of example.
- For tasks like question answering, multiple choice questions... multiple sequences were sent for each task
e.g. training example for question answering task comprised of sequences for context, question and answer.

Training: 100 epochs pretraining, 3 epochs for fine-tuning



GPT-2 (2019)

	Parameter	layer	dim	context token size	attention
• GPT-1	117M	12	768	512	12
• GPT-2	1.5B	48	1600	1024	20

>10 times more parameters, 10 times more data, i.e., 40GB text

- One unsupervised model for multi-tasking.
No fine tuning for specific tasks (no supervised learning)
- Language model - task conditioning: **P(output | input, task)**
– different output for same input for different task tokens.
- The model tries to understand the nature of task and provide answers (to emulate **zero-shot task** transfer).
- Inferior performance compared with supervised fine-tuning state-of-the-art methods.
- **One-shot** example: English to Chinese translation task,
input: I like to eat => 我喜欢吃 ;
I want to go to market today =>

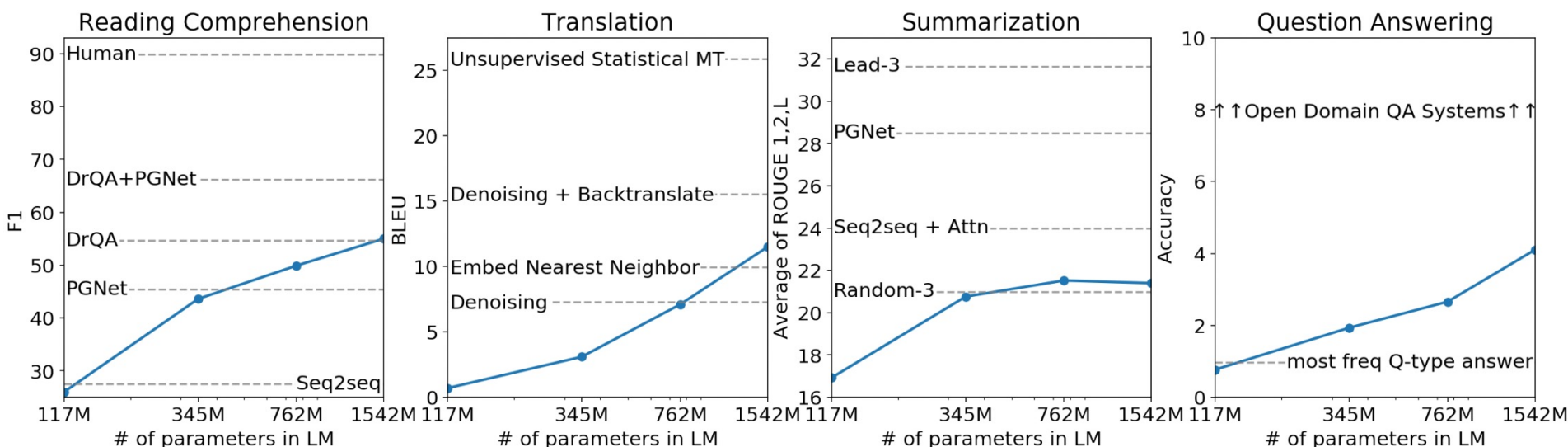
GPT2 : 我今天想去市场



GPT-2 Model Size and Perplexity

- Four language models were trained with 117M (same as GPT-1), 345M, 762M and 1.5B (GPT-2) parameters.
- Each subsequent model had better performance than previous one
- Performance (perplexity) improves with increase in no. of parameters (larger model) and longer training time on the same-dataset

i.e., GPT-2 under fitted the dataset.



Training LLM

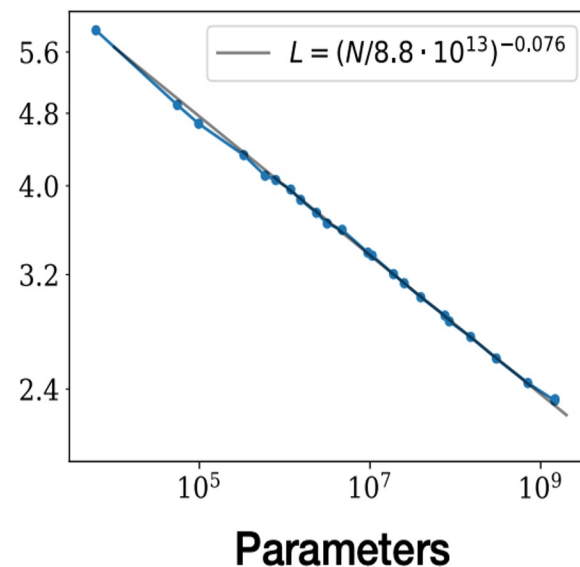
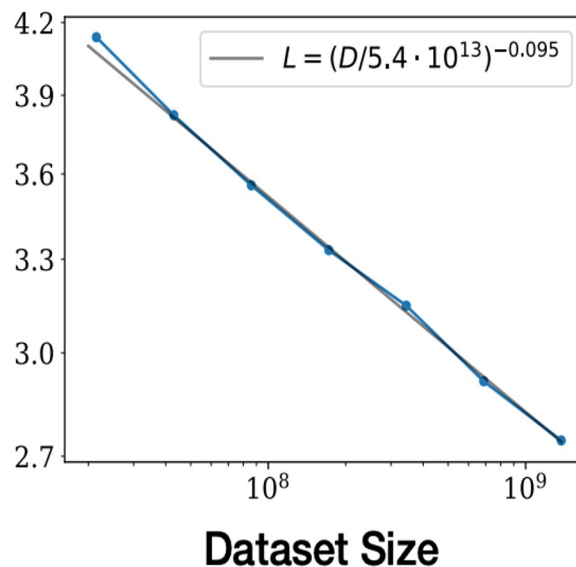
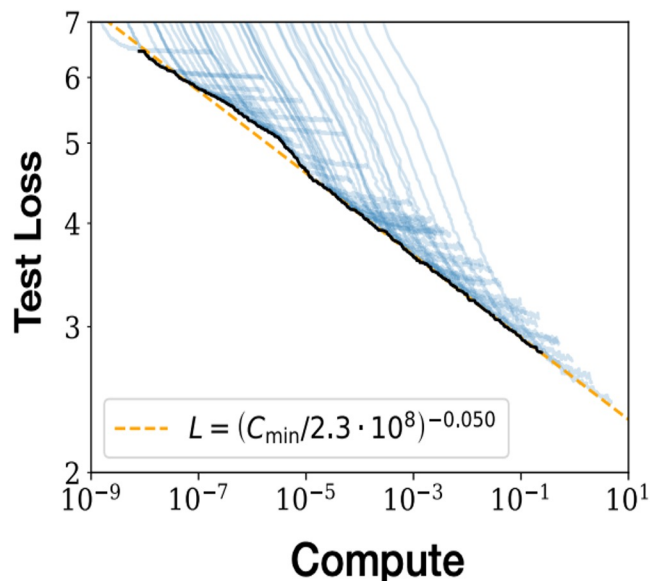
Training Compute-Optimal Large Language Models.
DeepMind. 2022.

Three key components of training LLMs (size >1B):

- **Model scale (N)**: number of parameters, layers and self-attention layers, and size of embedding size.
- **Dataset size (D)**: exhausting the Web data to pretrain LLM and curating a pretraining dataset takes time
- **Training Compute budget (C)**: most LLMs are undertrained.

LLM performance improves smoothly as we increase model size, dataset size, and the compute for training

Power-law relationship of performance $\sim (1/X)^\alpha$ for $X=N,D,C$



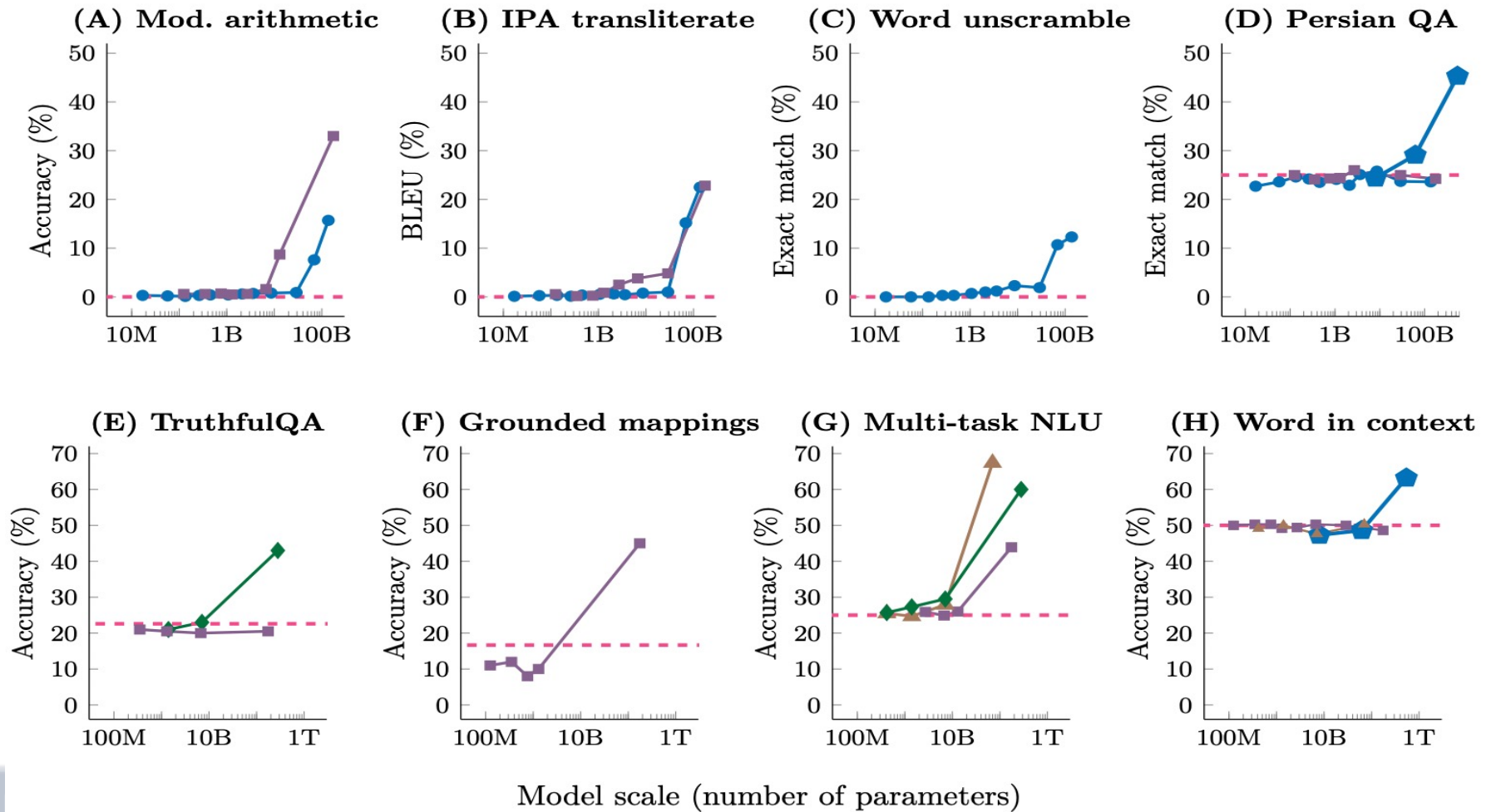
Emergent Abilities – the most prominent feature in LLMs

Emergent Abilities of Large Language Models. Google. 2022.

An ability to be *emergent* if it is not present in smaller models but is present in larger models.

The larger the better?

—●— LaMDA —■— GPT-3 —◆— Gopher —▲— Chinchilla —◆— PaLM - - - Random



GPT-3 (2020)

Tom Brown, et. Language Models are Few-Shot Learners, <https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2005.14165>, May 2020

- 175B parameters (1.5B - GPT-2), 96 layers, 96 attention heads, word embedding size 12888 (1600 - GPT-2), context size 2048 (1024 - GPT-2),
- few-shot learning without fine-tuning
- Data: ~500B tokens; 750+GB text from Webs, books, ...
- Due to large model and extensive dataset, GPT-3 is a good text completion model, e.g., writing essays, text summarization, answering questions, language translation, and computer coding ...

Generative AI system: A **low variance (temperature closer to 0)** may produce similar or repetitive samples, resulting in poor generation, whereas, a **high variance (temperature closer to 1)**, may yield diversified but unrealistic or incoherent samples.

Let $z' = z/T$ where $T \in (0, 1)$, prob of each word = softmax (z')

- Striking a balance between **variation** and **fidelity** is difficult, trade-off between exploring and exploiting the data distribution.

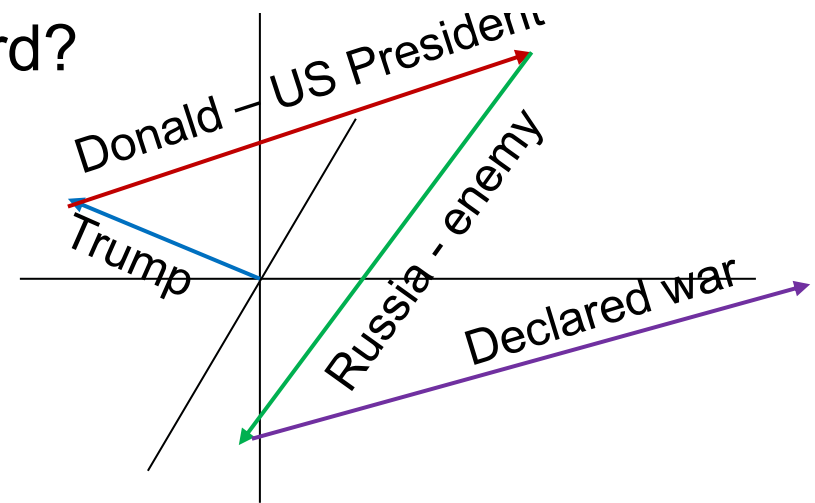


Next word prediction

- Russia has declared war on the United States after Donald Trump accidentally **pressed the wrong button....***

GPT3 : How to predict next word?

1. Trump – embedding
2. Attention with
 - Donald (US President)
 - Russia (competing country)
 - Declared war



Depending on attention and temperature

Next word	sat	pressed	fired	looked	spoke	and	a	the	...	
Probability %	2.5	2.35	2.3	2.01	1.5	0.05	0.09	0.08	...	

Context (GPT3 - 2048 words) more precise answer

Early version of ChatGPT forgets long conversation

Decoder – generate next word

Translation Source $X \rightarrow$ Target Y

$$Y_{\text{best}} = \operatorname{argmax}_Y P(Y|X)$$

Exhaustive search is very expensive, B^s sentences
where B = number of branches, s = sentence length

Greedy Search: next word with the highest probability.

$$y_j = \operatorname{argmax} P(y_j | X, y_1, \dots, y_{j-1})$$

might miss the best sentence and prefer common words

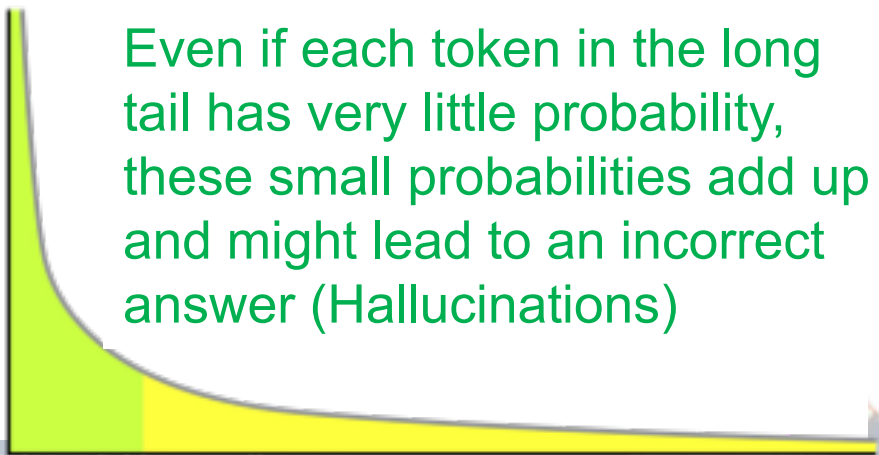
Beam Search: Breadth-first search on the top k (beam size)
most probable sequences at each decoding step

Problem: Lack of Diversity

Sampling from Distribution

$$y_j \sim P(y_j | X, y_1, \dots, y_{j-1})$$

- *Top-k, Top-p, ϵ -sampling, Stochastic Beam Search*



Even if each token in the long tail has very little probability, these small probabilities add up and might lead to an incorrect answer (Hallucinations)

Building LLM

- **LLMs are not intelligent, just statistical beasts.**
 - LLMs project a sense of “understanding” based on what they can do
 - They don’t “*understand*” text like humans do.
 - They predict the next most likely word based on vast amounts of training data. .
- **Building an LLM follows same 3-step logic as any ML model**
 - 1 **Collect massive amounts of data** (ideally the entire internet).
 - 2 **Train a *baseline model*** to capture patterns (autocomplete).
 - 3 **Improve the model** with fine-tuning to make it useful.
- **Baseline models are coherent but mostly useless.**

Predicting next word makes them sound *real*, but they have no reasoning, truthfulness, or intent. It’s “just” pattern matching.
- **Fine-tuning turns a random word predictor into an actual tool,**
i.e., knowledge, factual consistency, human alignment ...



Baseline Model

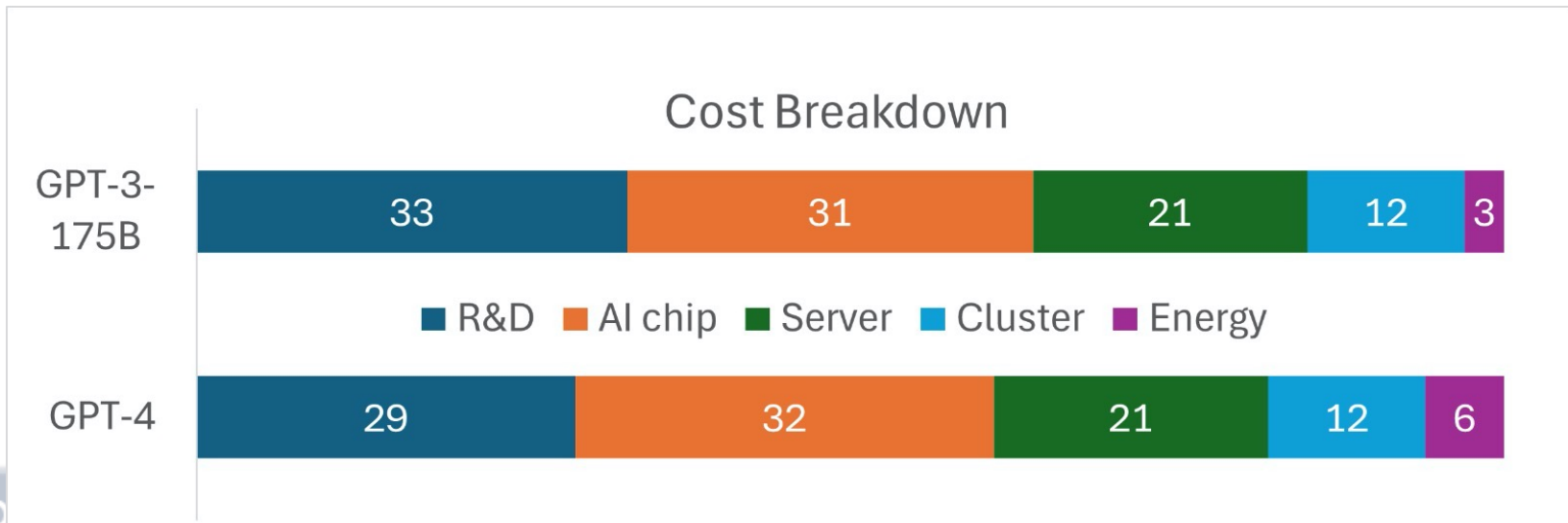
A baseline LLM model is just a probability machine.

It learns to predict the next token based on statistical patterns in training data, not meaning or reasoning.

- It is trained to predict next word with loss $\mathcal{L} = -\log p_y$
- It writes coherent sentences but diverges and hallucinates.

Training costs are astronomical. Accessible to only a few major players, which is why NVIDIA stock skyrocketed.

- Training Cost for GPT-3 (175B) ~\$4.6m, GPT-4 ~\$80-100m



Improve the Model by Fine-tuning

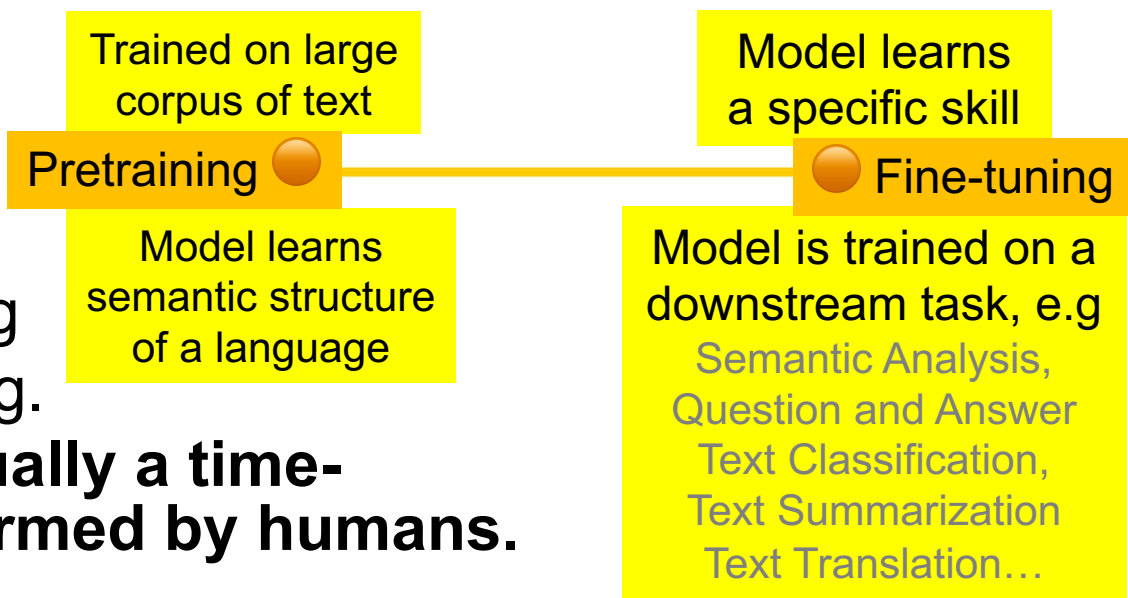
Aligning language models to follow instructions, <https://openai.com/research/instruction-following>, Jan 2022

GPT-3 is trained to predict next word on a large dataset, but cannot track user intent, i.e., not aligned with the users

- **Lack of helpfulness** - do not follow user's instructions.
- **Hallucinations** - reflect non-existing or incorrect facts.
- **Lack interpretability** - difficult for humans to understand how the model arrived at a particular decision/prediction
- **Toxic/biased content** - harmful/offensive misinformation

Fine-tuning requires a human-labeled dataset, large to allow the model to generalize its learning well and avoid overfitting.

Data annotation is usually a time-consuming task performed by humans.



GPT-3.5 / InstructGPT (2022)

Aligning language models to follow instructions, <https://openai.com/research/instruction-following>, Jan 2022

Trained with humans to follow user intentions (human preference)

- RLHF: Reinforcement Learning from Human Feedback
 - Incorporate human expertise and knowledge
 - Mitigate untruthful, toxic output and hallucination
 - Make models more aligned with users
- Humans rank many different outputs produced by model for various prompts (human feedback in RLHF)

- **GPT-3.5 / InstructGPT**: a fine-tuned version of GPT-3
- **RLHF**: Reinforcement Learning from Human Feedback
(**Step 1**: supervised fine-tuning (SFT))

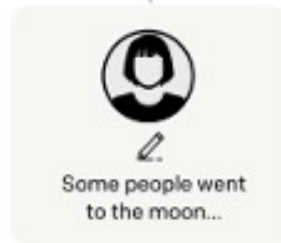
Step 1

**Collect demonstration data,
and train a supervised policy.**

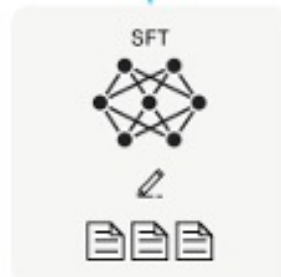
A prompt is
sampled from our
prompt dataset.



A labeler
demonstrates the
desired output
behavior.



This data is used
to fine-tune GPT-3
with supervised
learning.



Prompt dataset is a series of
prompts previously submitted to
the Open API

40 contractors
hired to write
responses to
prompts

Input / output pairs are used to
train a supervised model on
appropriate responses to
instructions.

Maximize diversity in the prompt dataset,
Only 200 prompts come from any given user
Any prompts that shared long common
prefixes were removed.

Three common prompts

Direct: “Tell me about...”

Few-shot: Given these two examples
write another story on the same topic.

Continuation: Given the start of
a story, finish it.

Example:

“What is the UK’s capital?”
The annotator needs to give
“the UK’s capital is London”

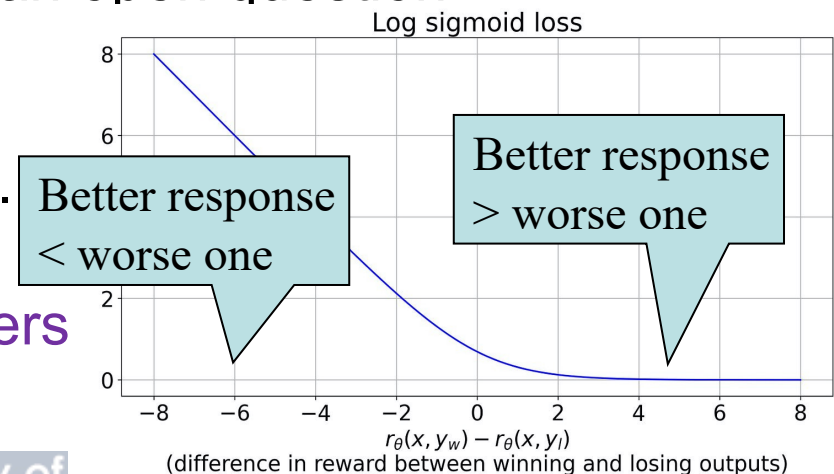
GPT-3.5 / InstructGPT (2022)

Aligning language models to follow instructions, <https://openai.com/research/instruction-following>, Jan 2022

Trained with humans to follow user intentions (human preference)

- RLHF: Reinforcement Learning from Human Feedback
 - Incorporate human expertise and knowledge
 - Mitigate untruthful, toxic output and hallucination
 - Make models more aligned with users
- Humans rank many different outputs produced by model for various prompts (human feedback in RLHF)
- Train a reward model that predicts which output humans will prefer
- Choosing best answer among two options is a much simpler task than providing an exact answer to an open question.
- Reward model generates positive values for good responses and negative values for bad responses.

$\mathcal{L}(\theta) = -\log(\sigma(r_{\theta}(x, y_w) - r_{\theta}(x, y_l)))$
prompt x , outputs y_w that human prefers
and y_l that they don't like as much.



- **GPT-3.5 / InstructGPT**: a fine-tuned version of the GPT-3
- RLHF: Reinforcement Learning from Human Feedback
(**Step 2**: reward model (RM) training)

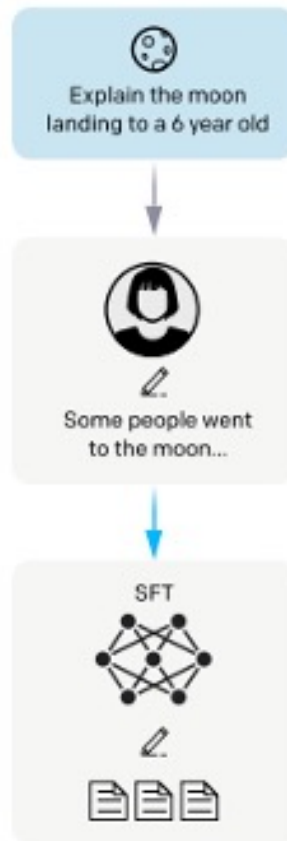
Step 1

Collect demonstration data, and train a supervised policy.

A prompt is sampled from our prompt dataset.

A labeler demonstrates the desired output behavior.

This data is used to fine-tune GPT-3 with supervised learning.



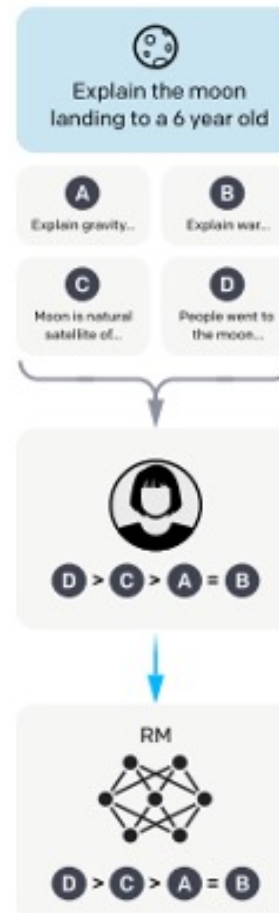
Step 2

Collect comparison data, and train a reward model.

A prompt and several model outputs are sampled.

A labeler ranks the outputs from best to worst.

This data is used to train our reward model.



Collecting human data is expensive and slow.

Responses are generated by the SFT model

Step 2 trains a reward model to replace human judgments.

Step 3 uses the model to interact with reward model (a simulated human annotator).

$\binom{k}{2}$ combinations of rankings served to the model as a batch datapoint

ChatGPT (2022) <https://chat.openai.com/>

- Large Language Model (LLM) based on GPT3 –
 - 175 billion parameters, 96 layers, 96 attention heads, embedding size 12888, input size 2048
 - Pretrained with data from web (~ 500 billion tokens; 750+GB of text)
- ChatGPT:
 - embedding size 1536 vs 12888 (GPT-3)
 - parameters 20 billion vs 175 billion (GPT-3)
 - input size 8192 vs 2048 (GPT-3)



Learn to understand meaning and relationship of input words (very precise description through large embedding size and many attention heads)

Generate fluent and coherent text from transformer decoder (depends on large model, lots of training data and good input embedding)



is a Big Hit

November 2022

- ChatGPT gained 1 million users in only 5 days
 - Over 100 million monthly active users within 2 months of launch
- Tik Tok reached 100 million in 9 months

ChatGPT Sprints to One Million Users

Time it took for selected online services to reach one million users



Fastest rising Application!

* one million backers ** one million nights booked *** one million downloads

Source: Company announcements via Business Insider/Linkedin

ChatGPT (2022) <https://chat.openai.com/>

- Predict the next word is not enough to make chatbot, e.g.,
 - if you asked GPT-3 to “Write an article about American football”
 - predicting next word
“.... and its influence on television in America.”
 - Conversation Protocol **finetuning** – specialized on prompting
 - User: Hi! I am a human
 - Assistant: Hello! Nice to meet you! I am ChatGPT, your AI assistant.
- create new tokens that represent an action,
e.g., OpenAI uses system tokens like <|im_start|> & <|im_end|>

Based on InstructGPT, ChatGPT incorporates (1) human feedback during training using reinforcement learning (2) slight differences in data collection setup and trained **specially optimized for dialogue**.

- **Step 1:** Train an InstructGPT model using Reinforcement Learning from Human Feedback (RLHF)
- **Step 2:** Human trainers use model-written suggestions to compose dialogue responses.
- **Step 3:** Mix this new dialogue dataset with the InstructGPT dataset in a dialogue format.

ChatGPT – Helpfulness vs. Harmlessness

ChatGPT is a strong, successful and popular AI tool

- helpful for many real-world NL tasks like Q&A, writing emails, making excel forms, writing programs, polishing essays, summarising complex research papers, analysing legal documents, writing poetry in different styles,...
- can generate human-like responses on science, history, or literature (surprising accuracy or totally made-up stuff).
- there is a tradeoff between helpfulness and harmlessness.
 - stress more on helpfulness, tend to increase harmfulness.
 - stress more on harmlessness, tends to refuse to answer in many cases. This reduces helpfulness.
- need **balance between helpfulness and harmlessness.**



ChatGPT - Limitations

1. plausible-sounding but **incorrect/nonsensical answers**
 - RL training gives no source of truth (**Hallucination**);
 - training the model more cautious might decline correct answers (**Helpfulness vs. Harmlessness**)
 - supervised training based on available data, not what human knows
2. **sensitive to tweaks** to input phrasing or attempting the same prompt multiple times.
3. **excessively verbose** and overuses certain phrases, from biases in the training data (trainers prefer longer answers that look more comprehensive)
4. guess user's intent (instead of asking for clarifications) for **ambiguous query**.
5. respond to **harmful instructions** or exhibit **biased behavior**.

ChatGPT – Importance of Data Privacy

- Jasper AI (<https://www.jasper.ai/>) provides AI copywriter services without their own in-house models.
- Jasper is an early customer of OpenAI APIs.
- OpenAI found that Jasper uses its APIs to write emails and essays.
- ChatGPT enhances its abilities in writing emails and essays.
- People turn to use ChatGPT instead of Jasper.
- This raises issues about data privacy when using ChatGPT or large language models.

Note: OpenAI will record every prompt you sent to the OpenAI APIs!



GPT4 (2023)

GPT-4 visual input example, Extreme Ironing:

User What is unusual about this image?



Source: <https://www.barnorama.com/wp-content/uploads/2016/12/03-Confusing-Pictures.jpg>

GPT-4 The unusual thing about this image is that a man is ironing clothes on an ironing board attached to the roof of a moving taxi.

Table 16. Example prompt demonstrating GPT-4's visual input capability. The prompt requires image understanding.

GPT-4 (2023)

GPT-4 Technical Report, March 2023,
<https://arxiv.org/pdf/2303.08774.pdf>

- GPT-4 is a large multimodal model (image and text)
- No technical details were released (Section 2 in the paper):
“This report focuses on the capabilities, limitations, and safety properties.... Given both the competitive landscape and the safety implications of large-scale models like GPT-4, this report contains no further details about the architecture (including model size), hardware, training compute, dataset construction, training method, or similar. ...” (guess: 1.7T, 120att)
86B neurons with 100T parameters (human brain)
- Passes a simulated bar exam with a score around top 10% of test takers; GPT-3.5's score was around bottom 10%.
- GPT-4 can generate responses of more than 25,000 words, while GPT-3.5 is limited to about 3,000-word responses.
- 82% less likely to respond to requests for disallowed content
40% more likely to produce factual responses than GPT-3.5
- GPT-4 with context windows of 8192 and access 32768 tokens, while GPT-3, which were limited to 4096 and 2048 tokens

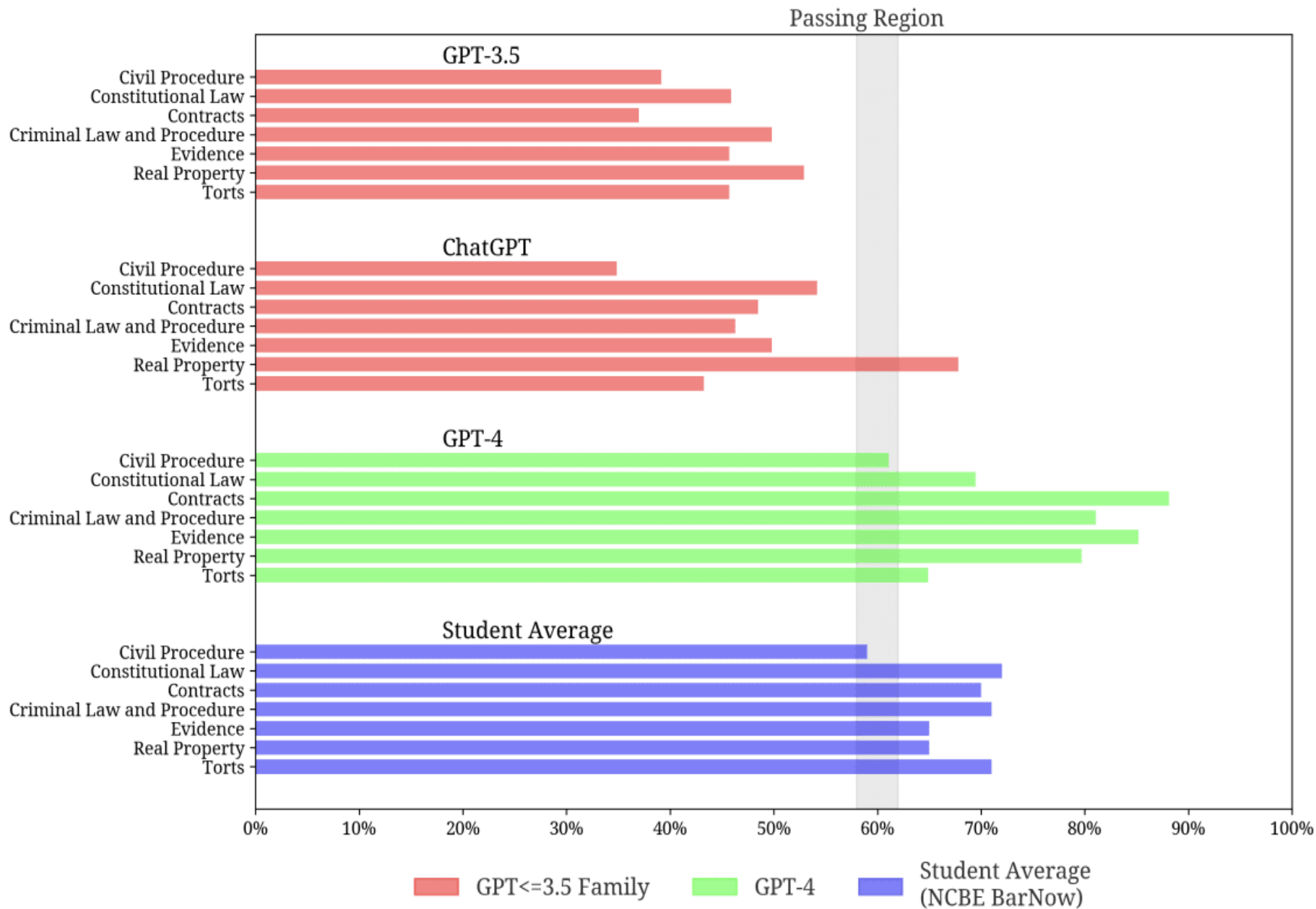


Figure 2. Progression of Recent GPT Models by Legal Subject Area

GPT-5 (2025)

Three Upgrades

1. **Model selector** -

no switching between different models, unified system decides how much processing

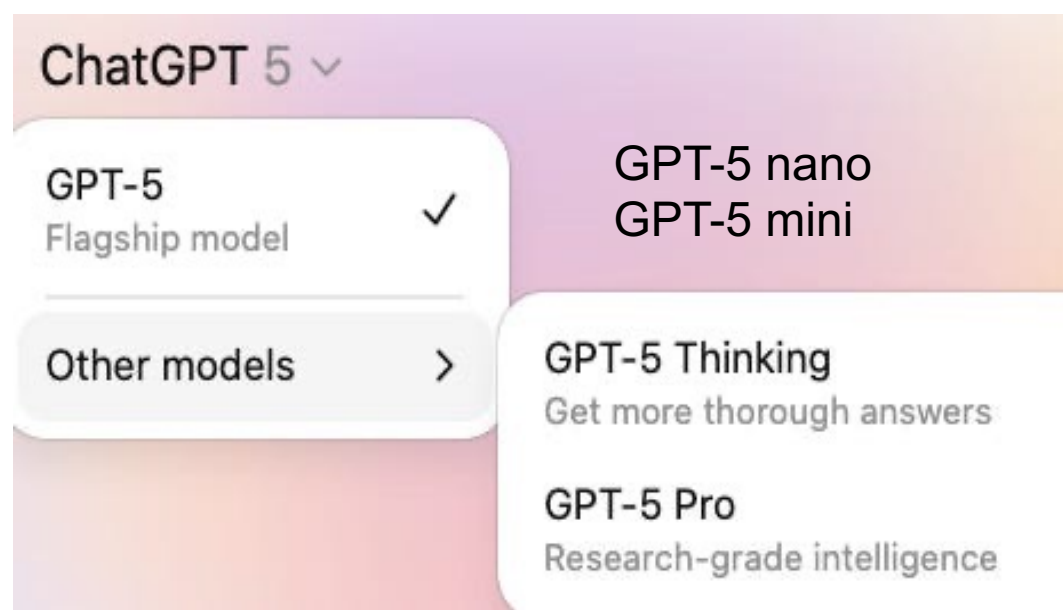
power to apply based on the complexity of the request.

2. **Fewer hallucinations** - 80% fewer factually incorrect statements; simply answer such as “I can’t do that,”

3. **Create apps** in seconds (even without a programming background) and perform well in tests, math competition

Other Upgrades - beyond grammar, correctness, tone, style,

- Medical advice - raise concerns, ask clarifying questions, and adjust its explanations based on the user’s context.
- Multimodal – interpret chart, diagram, photo, presentation



How LLMs collect and clean training data

- **Garbage in, garbage out** applies to LLMs.
vast, diverse, and well-structured training data to be effective.
- **LLMs need trillions of tokens** for models of trillion parameters

GPT4 1.8T parameters 13T tokens (9.7T words)

Deepseek V3 0.6T parameters 15T tokens (11.1 words)

- **Not all internet text is valuable.** (45T -> 570G)
Webpage formatting,
spam, duplicated content,
misleading information

Dataset	Size (GB)	Training Weight	epoch
Wikipedia	3	3%	3.40
WebText	20	21%	2.90
books	67	16%	2.33
crawl	400	60%	0.44

- Common crawl – messy, noisy, duplicate, but open, largest free data, 250B pages (3-5B new pages / month) – Fineweb project
- **Pre-training isn't enough.** After collecting and cleaning data, companies refine it with careful filtering and deduplication before even starting model training.

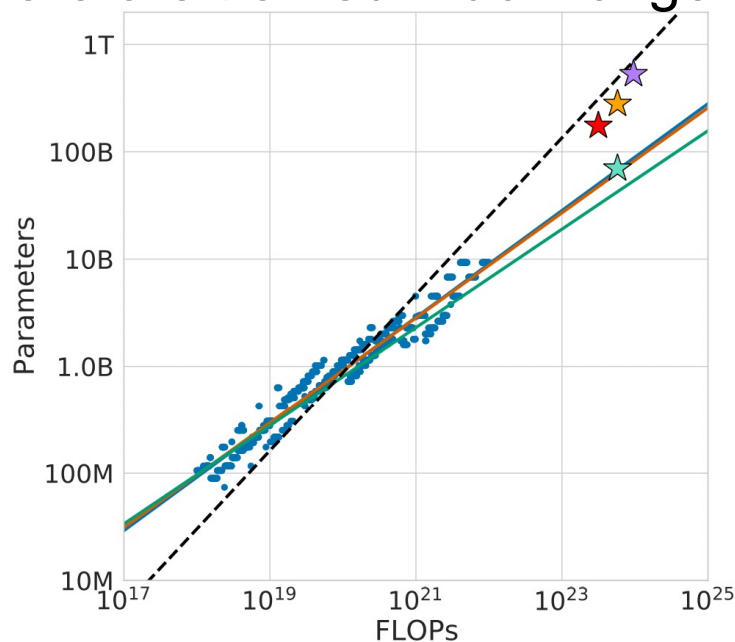


Optimal Large Language Models

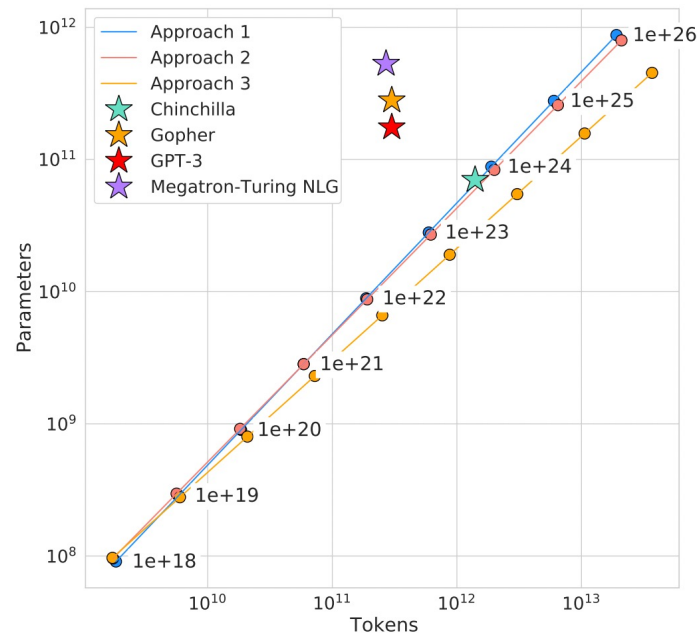
- Large models are more **sample-efficient** than small models, i.e., reaching same performance with fewer training steps.

How many data do we need to train a large model?

- Model size and training data should be scaled equally i.e., doubling of model size, doubling of training data
- A large model is not necessary if not enough training data.
- Current large models should be substantially smaller and therefore trained much longer than is currently done



Optimal Compute Given the Model Scale



Optimal Data Size Given the Model Scale